50pick — how rates and payouts are calculated

A guide for administrators. Covers both games: normal polls and Up & Down.

50pick does not set odds. Both games are **pari-mutuel**: the players' own money makes the price. We take a fee from the losing side, and everyone on the winning side shares what is left, in proportion to what they staked.

One rule, both games. Up & Down and normal polls are charged in exactly the same way. The games differ in how the result is decided and how long they last — never in how the money is worked out.

1. The rates

Item	Normal polls and Up & Down — identical
Our fee	**13% of the losing side** (Platform 3% + Operator 10%). Nothing is taken from the winners' stakes.
Tax on our fee	TRA 10% + GBT 5% *of the fee we earned*. Never taken from a player's payout.
Minimum stake	TZS 500 (since 12 October 2026; it was TZS 1,000)
Maximum stake	TZS 1,000,000 — **per bet**
Positions per market	As many as the player wants, on either or both sides.
Bonus betting requirement	Only **one side** of a market counts toward clearing a bonus. The player is warned before confirming, and the bet still goes ahead.
Free cancellation	5 minutes after placing the bet, full refund. After that the bet is locked.
Withdrawal fee	1.5% of the amount withdrawn
Minimum deposit	TZS 1,000
Minimum withdrawal	The smallest amount that still leaves at least TZS 1,000 after the fee — **TZS 1,015** at a 1.5% fee (the fee is rounded to the shilling). The withdrawal screen states it.

Rates are frozen when a market is created. Changing a rate today affects new polls and new rounds only — never a bet that has already been placed. Two markets running side by side can legitimately settle on different rates, so if a player disputes a payout, read the rates on *their* market.

Because the maximum is per bet, and players may place as many bets as they like, a player's total money on one market is not limited by that maximum. Their balance and the daily loss limit are what bound it.

2. How every payout is worked out

1. **The pool** — all the money in the market: winning side + losing side.
2. **Our fee** — 13% of the losing side.
3. **The net pool** — pool minus fee. This is what gets shared out.
4. **Each payout** — the player's stake ÷ the winning side × the net pool.

A payout always **includes the stake**. A player who stakes 60,000 and is paid 86,100 has made a profit of 26,100.

> **A winning bet is never paid less than it staked.** The fee only ever comes out of the losing side, so the winners' own stakes are untouched — whatever the shape of the market. Even on a market as lopsided as 999,000 against 1,000, a winning 10,000 bet on the crowded side still pays 10,009.

3. Game one — normal polls

The result is decided by an officer, on evidence, after the event. Polls can run for days or weeks.

Example 1 — a two-sided poll: "Will Simba win the derby?"

Player	Side	Stake
Amina	YES	60,000
Juma	YES	40,000
Neema	YES	100,000
Bakari	NO	80,000
Chausiku	NO	20,000
YES 200,000 · NO 100,000		**Pool 300,000**

In this case: YES wins

Losing side = NO 100,000. Fee = 13% × 100,000 = **13,000**. Net pool = **287,000**.

	Player	Stake	Paid	Profit / loss
From the winners	Amina	60,000	86,100	+26,100
	Juma	40,000	57,400	+17,400
	Neema	100,000	143,500	+43,500
From the losers	Bakari	80,000	0	−80,000
	Chausiku	20,000	0	−20,000
From the house	Fee earned		13,000	
	TRA 10% · GBT 5%		−1,300 · −650	
	50pick keeps		**11,050**	

Check: 287,000 paid + 13,000 fee = 300,000 pool. Every winner returned 1.435× their stake.

In this case: NO wins

Losing side = YES 200,000. Fee = 13% × 200,000 = **26,000**. Net pool = **274,000**.

	Player	Stake	Paid	Profit / loss
From the winners	Bakari	80,000	219,200	+139,200
	Chausiku	20,000	54,800	+34,800
From the losers	Amina	60,000	0	−60,000
	Juma	40,000	0	−40,000
	Neema	100,000	0	−100,000
From the house	Fee earned		26,000	
	TRA 10% · GBT 5%		−2,600 · −1,300	
	50pick keeps		**22,100**	

Check: 274,000 paid + 26,000 fee = 300,000 pool. Every winner returned 2.740× their stake.

What this shows. Same poll, same rate — a winning NO ticket returned 2.740× while a winning YES ticket returned 1.435×. Nobody set those numbers. NO was the smaller side, so fewer people shared a bigger prize. **The smaller side always pays better.**

Example 2 — a lopsided poll: a heavy favourite

Player	Side	Stake
Amina	YES (favourite)	300,000
Juma	YES (favourite)	150,000
Bakari	NO (outsider)	50,000
YES 450,000 · NO 50,000		**Pool 500,000**

In this case: the favourite (YES) wins

Losing side = NO 50,000. Fee = 13% × 50,000 = **6,500**. Net pool = **493,500**.

	Player	Stake	Paid	Profit / loss
From the winners	Amina	300,000	329,000	+29,000
	Juma	150,000	164,500	+14,500
From the loser	Bakari	50,000	0	−50,000
From the house	Fee earned		6,500	
	TRA 10% · GBT 5%		−650 · −325	
	50pick keeps		**5,525**	

Check: 493,500 paid + 6,500 fee = 500,000 pool. Every winner returned 1.097× their stake.

In this case: the outsider (NO) wins

Losing side = YES 450,000. Fee = 13% × 450,000 = **58,500**. Net pool = **441,500**.

	Player	Stake	Paid	Profit / loss
From the winner	Bakari	50,000	441,500	+391,500
From the losers	Amina	300,000	0	−300,000
	Juma	150,000	0	−150,000
From the house	Fee earned		58,500	
	TRA 10% · GBT 5%		−5,850 · −2,925	
	50pick keeps		**49,725**	

Check: 441,500 paid + 58,500 fee = 500,000 pool. The winner returned 8.830× their stake.

The complaint this answers: "I won but got almost nothing." Backing an overwhelming favourite means splitting a small prize among a large side — 1.097×, or 9.7% profit. It is not a fee problem: our fee there was 6,500 on a pool of 500,000, about 1.3%. Show the player the two pool figures on their poll.

If one side is empty. With nobody on the other side there is no prize and no fee. Every stake is returned in full, whichever way the event went, and 50pick earns nothing.

4. Game two — Up & Down

The money works exactly as in section 2 — 13% of the losing side. What is different is that Up & Down asks two separate questions: **the price band decides who wins, the pool decides how much**. A player can be right about the direction and still be refunded, if the price did not move far enough.

Who wins — the band

When the round opens we freeze the price and set two boundaries around it:

- Close **at or above the upper boundary** → UP wins.
- Close **at or below the lower boundary** → DOWN wins.
- Close **anywhere in between** → the round voids: every stake refunded in full, and we charge nothing.

Today the band is the asset's smallest meaningful move — on Bitcoin's 5-minute round that is four hundredths of a dollar — so in practice the round is simply “higher or lower” and refunds are rare. Gold's 15-minute round is the exception: it runs a wider 0.05% band, so a void there is normal.

Example 1 — a two-sided round (Bitcoin, 5 minutes)

Player	Side	Stake
Amina	UP	120,000
Juma	UP	80,000
Bakari	DOWN	100,000
Chausiku	DOWN	50,000
UP 200,000 · DOWN 150,000		**Pool 350,000**

In this case: the price closes higher → UP wins

Losing side = DOWN 150,000. Fee = 13% × 150,000 = **19,500**. Net pool = **330,500**.

	Player	Stake	Paid	Profit / loss
From the winners	Amina	120,000	198,300	+78,300
	Juma	80,000	132,200	+52,200
From the losers	Bakari	100,000	0	−100,000
	Chausiku	50,000	0	−50,000
From the house	Fee earned		19,500	
	TRA 10% · GBT 5%		−1,950 · −975	
	50pick keeps		**16,575**	

Check: 330,500 paid + 19,500 fee = 350,000 pool. Every winner returned 1.653× their stake.

In this case: the price closes lower → DOWN wins

Losing side = UP 200,000. Fee = 13% × 200,000 = **26,000**. Net pool = **324,000**.

	Player	Stake	Paid	Profit / loss
From the winners	Bakari	100,000	216,000	+116,000
	Chausiku	50,000	108,000	+58,000
From the losers	Amina	120,000	0	−120,000
	Juma	80,000	0	−80,000
From the house	Fee earned		26,000	
	TRA 10% · GBT 5%		−2,600 · −1,300	
	50pick keeps		**22,100**	

Check: 324,000 paid + 26,000 fee = 350,000 pool. Every winner returned 2.160× their stake.

And if the price barely moves: the round voids. All four players get their full stake back — Amina 120,000, Juma 80,000, Bakari 100,000, Chausiku 50,000 — and our fee is zero. This is a designed outcome, not a fault.

Example 2 — almost everyone on one side

Player	Side	Stake
Amina	UP	200,000
Juma	UP	100,000
Bakari	DOWN	30,000
UP 300,000 · DOWN 30,000		**Pool 330,000**

In this case: UP wins — the crowded side

Losing side = DOWN 30,000. Fee = 13% × 30,000 = **3,900**. Net pool = **326,100**.

	Player	Stake	Paid	Profit / loss
From the winners	Amina	200,000	217,400	+17,400
	Juma	100,000	108,700	+8,700
From the loser	Bakari	30,000	0	−30,000
From the house	Fee earned		3,900	
	TRA 10% · GBT 5%		−390 · −195	
	50pick keeps		**3,315**	

Check: 326,100 paid + 3,900 fee = 330,000 pool. Every winner returned 1.087× their stake.

In this case: DOWN wins — the thin side

Losing side = UP 300,000. Fee = 13% × 300,000 = **39,000**. Net pool = **291,000**.

	Player	Stake	Paid	Profit / loss
From the winner	Bakari	30,000	291,000	+261,000
From the losers	Amina	200,000	0	−200,000
	Juma	100,000	0	−100,000
From the house	Fee earned		39,000	
	TRA 10% · GBT 5%		−3,900 · −1,950	
	50pick keeps		**33,150**	

Check: 291,000 paid + 39,000 fee = 330,000 pool. The winner returned 9.700× their stake.

Notice what the fee did. When the crowded side won we earned 3,900; when the thin side won we earned 39,000. That is the same 13% rule both times — it is the losing side that changed size. Our income follows how the players lined up, and never comes out of a winner's own stake.

5. The two games, side by side

	Normal polls	Up & Down
Our fee	**13% of the losing side — identical**	
Stake limits	**500 minimum · 1,000,000 maximum per bet — identical**	
Who decides the result	An officer, on evidence, with an objection window	The price feed, automatically, at the boundary
How long it runs	Days or weeks	3 to 60 minutes
Can everyone be refunded?	If one side is empty, or the poll is cancelled	Also whenever the price stays inside the band

If a customer asks what we charge, there is now one answer for the whole platform: 13% of the losing side, and nothing from the winners.

50pick — internal guide for administrators. Rules agreed 14 August 2026; the minimum stake lowered to TZS 500 on 12 October 2026. Every figure was produced by 50pick's own settlement calculation at the rates in section 1. Markets opened before these rules take effect settle on the rates that were frozen onto them at the time.